



Men made the internet...

Said the first line of a NYT article. Naturally there was a feminist backlash. To find out more, head over to <http://digit.in/MkkNUw>

The Superman experience

Google Earth goes 3D. Now you can move around, rotate and interact with 3D images of the cities, at the touch of your phone. <http://digit.in/KPnfGA>

Budget smartphones

App store and its appearance is quite similar to other Samsung phones, thanks to the TouchWiz skin, but it is by far the weakest OS in this shootout.

ANDROID

The overall experience of the Samsung Galaxy Y Pro Duos feels lackluster considering that Gingerbread wasn't designed to run on such a small screen (2.6-inches) with a physical QWERTY keypad. But all isn't bad. The device ran all the apps we threw at it with absolute ease but lagged during multitasking which is expected since the device runs on an 832MHz processor.

The Spice MI 350N too suffers from multitasking issues. Because of the 650MHz processor, you will be killing tasks faster than flies and face a lagging multitasking performance. The best part of the device is that it comes packed with quite a few preloaded apps such as the Delhi Metro app, a bunch of news apps, just dial, ibibo, SpiceGang and a few games. The 2.8-inch Samsung Galaxy Pocket can be easily described as an entry-level Android packet. It's got an 832 MHz processor, which gets the job done in terms of running apps. It was also one of the best performers in terms of the benchmarks. Its like they say, some of the best things come in small packages.

In terms of its features, the Micromax A50 Ninja is just like all the other Android phones on this list. Where it outshines the others is with the preloaded voice assistant called Aisha. There are a few reasons why Aisha is a treat to work with. For starters, she understands the Indian accent better than Siri and is more apt for the India user. Secondly and most importantly,

HOW WE TESTED

For budget smart phones there are a few essentials that need to be looked at. For starters, the devices need to function as a phone and take care of the basics – making calls and text messaging. For this, we tested the phones in 3 conditions – full signal strength, half signal strength and minimum signal strength – to judge the performance of the call quality. We also considered the quality of audio at both while speaking as well as listening. The quality of the loudspeaker was looked at as well. Some of these devices are dual SIM where as the others support single SIM.

As far as texting goes, some devices were touch-screen, others showed off a QWERTY keypad. We tested the ease of typing, response and flexibility of each. Ease, comfort, error during typing and the comfort for prolonged typing were tested.

Since these devices boast of the ability of being

smart, they need to be able to do a lot more than the basics. We ran benchmarks on the devices to see the performance of the raw power under the hood. Since the OSes are diverse, the average of the benchmarks were used to compensate for the devices that didn't support certain benchmarks. We also ran multimedia on the device – songs, YouTube videos and played some games to see how they performed.

Music is something we all keep on our smartphones and we tested the device by playing some Nickelback and judging the output of the smartphones speakers as well as the bundled headphones. We also judged the devices on the basis of their overall build quality, the display size, resolution, colour representation and depth. Since these are budget phones, we didn't expect stellar performance from the cameras but we tested their output nonetheless.



Spice MI-350n

if you have a quirky conversation with her about your love life or death, the answers you receive go beyond hilarious! When we turned on the Aisha app for the first time, it asked for an update. We recommend that you too update the device so that the app works effectively. The app identified locations, searched the web and also claimed that the iPhone is the best phone in the world. An affair brewing between Aisha and Siri?

SYMBIAN S40

The Nokia 303 is a Symbian device, which means that its app ecosystem isn't the best but there are a few things to look out for. The device comes preloaded with apps such as Angry Birds, FIFA, NFS, news apps, maps and access to the Nokia Ovi store. The best part is that the device ran all these apps very well.

The Nokia Asha 302 and Asha 200 are Nokia's entry-level devices. They may not be as app-friendly as the Asha 303, but you can expect to do the basics such as social networking, a bit of web browsing and access apps from the Nokia Ovi store nonetheless – just don't expect a stellar experience. One of the best features of the Symbian OS is that it isn't as intimidating as Android is to new comers. Anyone who has ever used a Nokia phone will feel right at home. The OS also offers you the ability to customise the home screen, which allows you to launch all of your most frequently used apps straight from the home

screen. The customisation may not be as elaborate as Android – which offers you widgets and multiple home screens – but it is very useful nonetheless.

BADA

If rumours are to be believed, Samsung might stop developing bada further, in order to focus on Tizen. If this is true, then you may not find any more bada devices soon, so keep your eyes peeled. The



Micromax A50